

MONTHLY TEAM SYNC . OCTOBER 2026

PLATFORM ENGINEERING AND AI FOR IT

New faces, what we delivered, how IT4IT connects to our work, and where I need your help.

Chris Thompson, AVP Platform Engineering and AI for IT Americas . 45 minutes

L'OREAL
BEAUTY TECH



AGENDA

WHAT WE WILL COVER

Seven parts, 45 minutes. Stop me with questions at any point.

People, delivery, direction, and a few asks

	Welcome and new team members Naveen, Jordan, Yomara and Joe	5 min
	What we delivered since July Application delivery, platform, and ServiceNow	10 min
	IT4IT and how it connects to our work Michael's roadmap and what changes for the team	6 min
	AI tooling: tokens and monitoring Working across L'Oreal GPT, Copilot and Claude Code	7 min
	Where I need your help Five workstreams, one high priority	7 min
	Year-end reviews and housekeeping Review status and attendance	4 min
	Wrap-up and open floor Your questions, blockers and ideas	6 min

WHAT I WANT YOU TO LEAVE WITH

- You know who has joined and what each person is here to do
- You have seen how much this team shipped since July
- You know how to work within the token limits, and that I am pushing on them
- You know which five workstreams need hands

WELCOME TO THE TEAM

Four people have joined us since the last sync. Please introduce yourselves this week if you have not already.

Naveen joins as Director, plus two interns and an AWS lead



Naveen Chinta

Director, effective October 1

Where he comes from

Three years on NEO US, most recently as integration architect on the GK NEO Remediation program. He knows the inventory flows between GK, OMS, S4 and Azure PaaS, and has worked with SalonCentric, Wipro, Accenture, Infosys and GK Software.

What he will do here

- Management support for the team: delivery coordination, planning and follow-through across our portfolio
- Follow-ups and status that DK carries today, so DK can stay on technical work
- Cleaner project data in ServiceNow: due dates and actual start dates



Jordan and Yomara

Winter interns, Hudson Yards

- Computer science students at BMCC, both graduating in December
- Part time around their class schedules
- Starting on OMS documentation, GK PSP support and the QA AI automation work



Joe Grande

AWS SME and project lead, contractor

- Here for the AWS email POC, our first AWS deployment
- Owns the milestones and the infrastructure coordination
- Works with DK and whoever joins the build

WHAT WE DELIVERED

Application delivery since our last sync on July 23. Sprints 8 through 11.

Forty stories closed across four sprints, and nothing left behind in Sprint 9

40

stories closed in Sprints 8 to 11

21 of 21

Sprint 9 stories closed

2 weeks

NIA build finished early

Oct 7

SBS fraud go-live, code deployed



NIA inventory aggregator

Build and unit test done July 31, two weeks early. SIT passed with no corrections from the business. Our app is ready and waiting on cutover dates.



PAS 2.0

Real-time push to S4 validated. Business agreed to release version one. Production API access is in hand and the first release is targeted for October.



Spend Tracker

Built from nothing: PO, budget and vendor spend APIs, the UIs, LDAP login and Azure infrastructure. Now in QA with a path to production being set.



SBS Commissions

G flag support shipped across the API, UI and message service. Guest checkout and fraud changes are deployed and in testing.



NEO data reconciliation

Mapping rules, change history and missing-record detail shipped. Business approved the reconciliation changes. Purchasing org rule in progress.



Also shipped

Strada Phase 1 through EA, privacy and security to ITRB. GK inventory source moved to HIP SFTP. Sovos monthly tax refresh. Xactly 6-step calculator.

PLATFORM, AI SDLC AND SC MOBILE

The work that does not show up as a shipped app but makes the rest possible.

SC Mobile, better tooling, and a pipeline that kept running



SalonCentric Mobile

Whole team ran the vendor app locally on iOS and Android. Full as-built documentation for both platforms is on Confluence, the vendor source sits in a L'Oreal repo for the first time, and our security findings are with the business and the vendor.



AI SDLC skills

Reviewed the global skills library and sent the findings back. Built our own TDD and observability skill. Windows setup for Claude Code is now the team standard. Supported OMS and OneSFA onboarding.



Pipeline and infrastructure

Cleared the broken Terraform pipeline after our DevOps contractor left. NIA infrastructure delivered as code. Beauty Connect and SC Mobile onboarded to the enterprise security scanning pipeline.



Advising QA on AI

Set up Gail's Workato testing team on the tools. Their L'Oreal GPT companion now compares TIBCO and Workato payloads; they report about 1.5 times the throughput and roughly 200 hours a month saved.

WORTH CALLING OUT

- Christopher was unanimously recommended for the Management Trainee program after his intern presentation
- DK's architect award nomination was approved in August
- Pri solved the Windows setup that had the rest of us stuck
- Deepthi was productive within her first week
- Knowledge transfer sessions on Azure, Kafka and logging are running

SERVICENOW AND IT4IT

Michael's side of the house:
platform releases for HR,
Workplace, Data and LATAM
sourcing.

Seven ServiceNow releases went live in one month

7

releases live, mid-July to mid-August

2.86 days

MyJourneys task completion vs a 5 day target

9 to 1

1LD data catalog items consolidated

~6 months

LATAM BEST ahead of the original plan



What went live

- MyJourneys onboarding and Employee Journeys for the US, 71 active journeys
- Employee Relations on the standard case model, with the custom US setup retired
- 1LD data business service, on the committed date, with named owners
- Workplace Service Delivery in Tampa and Montreal
- LATAM BEST sourcing, phases combined into one build, model reused by global



Platform and governance

- Americas is the only zone on Platform Analytics after the global upgrade
- Retail Ops service model: 160 topics mapped, 6 legal-reporting topics caught before build
- Playbook and portfolio-plan prototype for the CIO office process improvement ask
- IT4IT roadmap delivered on both dates, draft September 17 and final September 24
- Michael passed the CGEIT certification and was elected to the global ServiceNow user group board

IT4IT AND OUR WORK

Michael owns a platform engineering and IT4IT roadmap. Every line ends in something you can point to.

ServiceNow should show what our work is for, not just track it



The idea

- L'Oreal tracks applications and technology, but not the services above them
- Services get defined in ServiceNow with an accountable owner, an SLA and a support model
- Nothing goes on the roadmap without a named owner
- Americas work ties back to the global model instead of diverging from it



What changes for us

- Our roadmap and all ongoing work live in ServiceNow as demands, epics and stories
- Due dates and actual start dates get filled in, so delivery can be measured
- What we build and hand over is registered with an owner before it leaves us
- Michael will run a ServiceNow session for the team on how this fits together



Dates to watch

- Oct 2: OneSFA DevOps Change one-pager
- Oct 9: roadmap in ServiceNow with weekly status
- Oct 14: Knowledge 26 readout to Etienne
- Nov 30: decision-rights proposal
- Dec 11: 1LD Data and Supplier services with owner and SLA

TOKENS AND MONITORING

Allowances on Claude Code and Copilot were cut. Here is how we work within that for now.

Fewer tokens, three tools, and monitoring on the way



What changed and what it costs us

- Claude Code and Copilot allowances were reduced. L'Oreal GPT was not.
- People are hitting monthly caps within days and switching models mid-task
- Token-heavy helpers such as Pepe had to be turned off or rebuilt as scripts



Coming: monitoring of skill use

- Our global AI SDLC partners will install software that monitors use of the approved skills
- Expect telemetry on Claude Code first, then Copilot
- A quota model for both tools goes to the global steering committee on October 8

HOW TO SPLIT THE WORK FOR NOW



L'Oreal GPT

Plan, research and write the instruction file here. No token cap today, so do the thinking before you open the other two.



GitHub Copilot

Lighter in-editor work: small edits, completions, quick questions about the file in front of you.



Claude Code

Execute a plan you already wrote. Multi-file changes. Review PR diffs, not whole repositories.



I know this is hurting our performance. I have raised it with leadership and will keep pushing.

If you hit your cap, tell DK or me the same day. Increases can be requested, and the dates you ran out are the evidence I need.

WHERE I NEED YOUR HELP

Five workstreams are running at once. I cannot carry them alone. Tell Naveen, DK or me where you can take a piece.

Five workstreams need hands, and SC Mobile comes first

HIGH PRIORITY



SC Mobile

Where it stands

The app is IT-owned. Our role is technical advice and code review of the vendor's security fixes. iOS and Android documentation is on Confluence.

Help needed

- Review vendor PRs against our findings list
- Run secret and dependency scans on the diffs
- Keep the Confluence docs and the companion current as code changes



Tessera POC

Agentic AI for NEO LATAM data mapping. AI and security reviews cleared with conditions. DK leads day to day.

Help needed: Environment setup, a pseudonymization step, and reconciliation checks.



AWS Email POC

Deploy the existing email campaign app to AWS. Joe leads. Needs to finish before the December freeze.

Help needed: One dedicated developer, plus CI/CD and infrastructure support.



Larridin POC

Measures AI usage, spend and productivity. Charter reviewed with the vendor. Procurement intake will take 8 to 12 weeks.

Help needed: Two to four engineers as pilot participants, and the ServiceNow demand.



QA AI automation

Prototype that grades user stories and generates test cases. First scope is story grading.

Help needed: Review the code and docs, take small PRs, try it on your own stories.

REVIEWS AND ATTENDANCE

Two short items: where year-end reviews stand, and keeping attendance records current.

Year-end reviews are submitted, and attendance needs your attention



Year-end reviews

I have reviewed the year-end forms and submitted my feedback for:



Michael



DK



Pri



Naveen

What happens next

- Ratings go through review and calibration with leadership
- Keep adding dates and evidence to your goals through year-end
- Questions about your own review: bring them to our 1:1



Keep your attendance up to date

Attendance for Ope's organization is down. Much of the gap is records, not presence.



Three days in the office is the requirement



Only your home location counts automatically. Log an alternate work location when you work from another office



At Hudson Yards, badge onto the floor, not just into the building



Update the system when you swap a remote day and an office day



Approved time off counts as an office day, so enter it

THANK YOU

Great work since July. Let's keep building.

Three things to take with you

1 We delivered

Forty stories, seven ServiceNow releases, and full documentation of a mobile app we inherited.

2 The token limits are real

Split work across the three tools, tell me when you hit a cap, and know that I am pushing on it.

3 Pick up a piece

SC Mobile first, then Tessera, AWS Email, Larridin and QA AI automation. Naveen will help coordinate.

COMING UP

Oct 5 to 8

Chris at the Americas IT leadership summit. DK covers.

Oct 7

SBS guest checkout and fraud go-live

Oct 8

Global AI SDLC steering committee: quotas and skills

Oct 9

IT4IT roadmap live in ServiceNow



Open floor

Questions, blockers, ideas. Anything on direction, tooling or workload. This is your time.